Access to Work (AtW) Application Guide: 2026 Edition

What is Access to Work? A UK government grant (managed by the DWP) designed to pay for practical support for neurodivergent professionals. It can cover 100% of the costs for specialist coaching and software, meaning **£0 cost to you or your employer.**

Phase 1: The Online Application (10 Minutes)

Go to: gov.uk/access-to-work

Key Info You'll Need:

- Your National Insurance (NI) number.
- Your workplace address and postcode.
- A contact name/email for your HR or Manager (the DWP usually notifies them that an application has been made).

Phase 2: Describing Your Challenges

The DWP needs to know how your ADHD or Autism impacts **your work specifically.** You can use these phrases as a baseline for your application:

For ADHD Focus:

"My ADHD leads to significant 'time-blindness' and difficulty with task prioritisation. I struggle with working memory, often losing track of complex instructions, which impacts my productivity and increases the risk of error. I require specialist strategy coaching and cognitive support tools to manage these workplace barriers."

For Autism/Sensory Focus:

"I experience high levels of sensory and social fatigue in the workplace, which can lead to cognitive shutdown. I struggle with navigating unwritten social rules and task-

switching. I require specialist neurodiversity coaching to develop energy-management strategies and communication tools to sustain my performance."

Phase 3: What to Ask For

When the DWP Assessor contacts you (usually 12-16 weeks after applying), tell them you have already identified a specialist provider and a specific protocol.

Request these three items:

1. **Specialist ADHD/Autism Coaching:** 12–20 sessions.
2. **Cognitive Remediation Software:** To improve working memory (e.g., Cogmed).
3. **Real-time Monitoring & Strategy Tools:** (EMA focus tracking).

Phase 4: Your Next Steps

Once you receive your **Award Letter** (the PDF or physical letter confirming your funding):

1. **Do not pay anything out of pocket.**
2. **Email the letter to:** info@riktapsykiatri.se
3. **We handle the rest:** We register with the DWP as your provider and set up **Direct Invoicing** so the government pays us directly.

Important 2026 Deadlines

- **Application Processing Time:** Currently 12–16 weeks.
- **Grant Validity:** Most awards are valid for 12 months. Apply now to ensure your support is in place for the next quarter.

Need help with your application? Book a free 15-minute AtW Guidance Call at https://riktapsykiatri.se/en/contact/